

CAMARONDICKMPEDIT

Sydney has its gems, especially around the rocks area right under the Sydney Harbour Bridge, and of course the famous Opera House. I went to a gorgeous French restaurant just under the bridge in the rocks. Travel Radio Australia, we are hugely honoured to be joined by Cameron Dick MP in Queensland, who is the Deputy Leader of the Queensland Opposition.

Cameron, welcome to the program. Great to be with you, Geoff. Now, Cameron, you were Deputy Leader of this great state of Queensland.

It's a fantastic state, isn't it? For people who haven't been here from overseas or whatever, tell us about your role in government and, you know, the great state itself. Well, we're very proud and parochial about Queensland, Geoff. You know, one of the best things I can ever tell people, particularly our friends from America, is that Queensland is two and a half times the size of Texas.

So we're bigger than Texas, and we're people with big hearts as well. But you're right, we are the great state of Australia, so we had incredible growth following COVID. So our economy came roaring out of COVID.

More jobs created in Queensland than in any other state in Australia. We had a very strong budgetary position, the biggest budget surplus in history, the lowest unemployment in history when I had the honour to be Treasurer. And so I think that set Queensland up for the future.

And we've got some terrific aspects of the Queensland economy, very strong in tourism, agriculture, our mineral resources, our construction industry. But we also, in our Labor government, we're on a very dedicated path to diversify the economy. So things like the space industry, aerospace, biomedical, biofuels, the renewal and recycling industry to take what was trash and turn it into treasure.

New products for the future. And I think that speaks to how dynamic our people are, how innovative our people are, and that we are a go get them state. I'm really proud of our time as a Labor government, but now we've got a job to do an opposition.

But we want Queensland to be strong, beautiful lifestyle, a beautiful place for people to come either to visit or to live. And we, of course, are welcoming people, welcoming people from around the world. Some of the things we supported as a government.

And I'm really proud to see our government, which really just supported and enabled some brilliant Queenslanders to deliver on their dreams and to show to the world that Queenslanders are really dynamic and exciting place to be. And I was speaking to Michael, the shadow tourism minister before, and the transport has really exploded in a great way because your government put in the 50 cent fares, which everybody is really enjoying now in South East Queensland. Well,

across the state.

So you can get a bus and train in metropolitan South East Queensland and a bus in regional Queensland, and it'll only cost you 50 cents. So that has two benefits or a number of benefits. It has the benefit of a cost of living relief measure to help families and individuals.

And it gets more cars off the road. So it has the environmental benefit of having more people in trains and buses. It, I think, sends the message that public transport matters and is important.

When you were deputy premier, I suppose you got to travel around the world a bit and talk to other people overseas about Queensland. And people have a very soft spot for this state when you talk to them internationally, I suppose. That's right, Jeff.

I had the great honour of being the deputy premier treasurer, but also trade minister. So I could work with our trade partners around the world to showcase our products, to open new markets and to help companies do more deals around the world. And Queensland, you're right, is a very attractive place.

There are many companies, other subnational governments like provinces or states, and also national governments themselves that want to do business with Queensland. But it's also the Queensland spirit, I think, which is friendly, open, but also very serious and genuine about partnerships that can build future relationships. You know, we're not a people that just want to sign a contract for the dollar figure that's attached.

We want to build relationships with people around the world to deepen our economy, to give opportunities for our people, but also to build great partnerships. And I think in a world that faces great trouble, where the world is more unstable than it's been for a long time, those people are people, state to state and country to country relationships have never been more important. And, you know, when you shake the hand of a Queenslander, you can do the deal and, you know, a Queenslander is a person of their word and will deliver on their promise.

And you've got some tremendous facilities in southeast Queensland, in particular, places like Movie World. A lot of people don't realise that the movies they're watching across the world, a lot of them are actually made at Movie World on the Gold Coast. Absolutely right, Geoff.

You know, that's a brilliant point. We have an exploding screen and film industry in Queensland, and we welcome all of those big name production companies from around the world to come to Queensland. But the beauty of places like the Gold Coast, not only can you work hard, you can play hard as well.

We've got some of the most beautiful beaches in the world that cost nothing for any tourist or visitor. We've also got great tourism offerings, and then we've also got great business opportunities too. So we might be a little bit, you know, I like to say, you know, we're humble in

Queensland, we've got it all.

That is, I think that's true. We love our friends from around the world to come and visit and experience Queensland, and we love to build those deep relationships as well. Cameron Dick, thank you so much for joining us here in Gladstone at the fantastic event with the local people here, and it's great to speak to you.

And we no doubt will see you guys back in the future here in Queensland in the leadership position at some point, and thank you for everything you guys have done for the state. Well, you're welcome. Jeff, thanks so much for having me on the program.

And to anyone listening around the world, you are welcome whenever you come to Queensland. Thank you very much for being on the program. Thanks, Jeff.